

Email Harvesting lab Report

The purpose of this lab was to understand how email addresses can be collected from publicly assessable web content using Python and regular expressions.

I created an authorized local HTML test page containing sample email addresses. I developed a python script using “re” module to search the HTML content for strings matching an email address pattern and finally the script successfully identified the email addresses contained in the test.

The email addresses that were successfully identified:

- info@example.com
- support@example.com
- security@example.com
- training@example.com

The local authorized test webpage “test_page.html” created specifically for this lab

The provided external test website was unreachable from my network, so a local authorized test page was used instead

Attackers can use publicly available email addresses to identify potential targets for phishing and other social engineering attacks. Knowing an organization’s email addresses can help an attacker create more convincing messages.

This explains why organizations should be careful about the information they expose publicly and should provide cybersecurity awareness training to employees.